

Ruoyu Wen

PhD Candidate in Product Design · Game Designer · HCI Researcher 📍 Christchurch, New Zealand | ✉️
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💡 Professional Summary

I bridge theoretical research and practical game development across cultures, with a focus on **Human-Agent Interaction**, **Virtual Reality (VR)**, and **Alternate Reality Games (ARGs)**. My objective is to create meaningful connections, foster cultural understanding, and cultivate inclusive experiences for diverse global audiences.

- **Core Expertise:** Game Design, Academic Research, Player Psychology, Immersive Entertainment (XR/VR), Conversational AI, Cross-cultural Studies.
- **Languages:** English, Chinese (Native).

🎓 Education

University of Canterbury, New Zealand | Christchurch, NZ *PhD in Product Design (HIT Lab NZ)* | 2023 – 2026

- **Focus:** Human-Agent Interaction, VR, ARGs, and player motivation leveraging Self-Determination Theory. Mixed-method research.

Uppsala University, Sweden | Uppsala, SE *Master of Art in Game Design* | 2021 – 2023

- **Focus:** Interactive Narrative, Player Psychology, User Experience Design, and Game Design Theory.

Huazhong University of Science and Technology, China | Wuhan, CN *Bachelor of Arts/Science in Communication Studies* | 2016 – 2021

- **Focus:** Digital Media, Social Media, Human-Computer Interaction Fundamentals, and Digital Culture.

📁 Experience

Game Designer | *MICROFEEL (Mobile Gaming)* | Remote Oct 2024 – Feb 2026

- Designed game experiences for mobile applications, combining HCI research insights with practical game design to create innovative mobile entertainment.

Visiting PhD Student | *KAIST (Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology)* | Daejeon, KR Oct 2025

- Conducted collaborative research on Extended Reality (XR) and Human-Computer Interaction at the GSCT UVR Lab.

Teaching Assistant | *University of Canterbury* | Christchurch, NZ Jul 2025 – Oct 2025

- TA for *Computation for Games*, supporting undergraduates in game development, programming, and computational foundations.

PhD Researcher / Research Assistant | *University of Canterbury (HIT Lab NZ)* | Christchurch, NZ 2023 – Present

- Conducted research in VR, Human-Agent interaction, and conversational AI.
- Participated in data collection, experiment design, and quantitative/qualitative analyses.
- Published works in leading HCI/Gaming conferences such as CHI, OzCHI, DiGRA, and SIGGRAPH Asia.

Research Intern | *NeXT SCENE (Immersive Entertainment)* | Shanghai, CN Apr 2022 – May 2022

- Investigated narrative-driven entertainment formats (Jubenshika/Escape Rooms) and player engagement in social gaming experiences.
- Developed frameworks for evaluating immersive experience design.

Strategy Investor Intern | *Huya (NASDAQ: HUYA)* | Guangzhou, CN Feb 2021 – Jun 2021

- Conducted market research and analyzed investment opportunities in the gaming and entertainment tech sectors for a major live-streaming platform.

Game Designer | *Chengdu ChuangLeHui (JOY NOVA)* | Sichuan, CN Mar 2020 – May 2020

- Contributed to mobile game concept development, gameplay mechanics design, and playtesting for "Champion of the Fields".

 Selected Publications

- **Can AI Prompt Humans? Multimodal Agents Prompt Players' Game Actions and Show Consequences to Raise Sustainability Awareness.** *CHI 2025.*
- **Exploring User Preferences for Museum Guides: The Role of Chatbots in Shaping Interactive Experiences.** *CHI 2025 Extended Abstracts.*
- **GenLinguaScape: Enabling User-Defined VR Scenarios for Communicative Language Practice.** *ISMAR 2025 Adjunct.*
- **Large Language Models for Automatic Detection of Sensitive Topics.** *OzCHI 2024.*
- **An Exploratory Study on AI-driven Visualisation Techniques for Decision Making in Extended Reality.** *OzCHI 2024.*
- **Sketchar: Supporting Character Design and Illustration Prototyping Using Generative AI.** *CHI Play 2024.*
- **Motivational Landscapes of ARG Players: A Self-Determination Theory Perspective.** *DiGRA 2024.*
- **Virtual Triplets: Mixed Modal Synchronous and Asynchronous Collaboration with Human-Agent Interaction in VR.** *CHI 2024 Extended Abstracts.*
- **I Light U Up: Exploring a New Emergent Narrative Paradigm through Light and Generative AI.** *SIGGRAPH Asia 2024 Art Papers.*
- **Listen to the Sword: Using Breathing and Spatial Audio for Wuxia Games.** *CHI 2024 Extended Abstracts.*
- **The Impact of Alternate Reality Games on Environmental Cognition for University Freshmen.** *HCI International 2024.*
- **Player Category Research on Murder Mystery Games.** *International Journal of Role-Playing 2023.*
- **The Chinese Hotpot of Larp.** *Knutpunkt 2022 Magazine.*